CHAPTER SEVEN:
MARKETING

The expectations for any big-budget motion picture are high, but when the film in question is Iron Man 2—the sequel to a movie that not only over-performed against even the highest expectations, a movie that launched Marvel Studios into the realm of producing its own films, and a movie that redefined the modern super hero film—"high" doesn't even begin to describe the expectations.

It falls to marketing to get the word out to the public; to prime the viewership for an experience that will thrill and amaze them. Modern-day film marketing comes in many forms: strategic partnerships, clever use of the Internet, dynamic trailers, exciting TV commercials—but perhaps no form of marketing for film is as iconic as the one-sheet movie poster.

Plastered across theater lobbies, billboards, bus stations, subway platforms, buses—the movie poster is a true art form in itself, with a history as rich and varied as the films being advertised.

Like any art form, the movie poster does not spring forth from nowhere. Instead, dedicated artists strike a delicate balance between art and commerce—between catching an eye and seducing a heart. The following pages show a sampling of some of the initial designs for Iron Man 2 posters...posters that might have been, images that are—in many ways—as phenomenal and enticing as the one-sheets that were used.

